Abdullah Al Zahid

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Sherwin de Castro
Human Resources
Transportation Services, City of Toronto

Re: Project Lead, Transportation Services (Job ID 67098)

Dear Sherwin de Castro,

I would like to be considered for one of the two Project Lead, Transportation Services positions in the Transportation Electrical Construction & Maintenance unit. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City, and before that I worked in GO rail service design at Metrolinx and on Ontario Line traffic simulation at Mott MacDonald.

Much of the role is project coordination and reporting in a complex municipal environment: managing projects from inception to completion, working across divisions, agencies and consultants, and preparing briefing materials and staff reports for senior management and Council. That is the shape of my work now. I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, planning the work and holding the schedule myself, and I coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict. I write the briefing notes, memos and presentations that carry issues to senior staff, and with policy staff I recommend and report to Council on new transportation regulations and guidelines.

On the technical side, I build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets the division depends on, using GIS and Python. At Mott MacDonald I ran Synchro traffic simulations to estimate how Ontario Line construction staging and road closures would affect the surrounding streets, and at Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. The posting asks for considerable experience in traffic signals, ITS or streetlighting, and I have not worked on the design, construction or maintenance of any of them. I have not managed capital construction projects or project budgets, led a procurement process or managed contractors, and I have not given work direction to staff. I do not hold a P.Eng. or PMP, which the posting lists as assets, and I do not currently hold a Class G licence, which the posting requires, so I would need to resolve that.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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